

[Company]		
BV Lead		Weighted Score
Date:		
Founder Name, Title		
LinkedIn		
Gender		
Ethnicity/Immigrant		
Age		
Schools and Degrees		
Prior Employers		
Technical Competence		
Publications & Citations		
Awards, Scholarships, Patents		
Other Achievements		
Founder X Factor		
Founder Co-Location?		
Repeat Founder?		
		Score (1-10)
BREAKTHROUGH IDEA - FOUNDER INSIGHTS AND WHY NOW		
Tests: can they articulate non-obvious insights and the inflection[s] that will enable their breakthrough idea? Is it credible and specific? Listen for: causal chain [X changed → Y possible → Z inevitable], living in the future Questions: What technological, scientific, or other key inflections are enabling your idea? Why is now the right time for this idea to work? What non-obvious insights do you hold about how your idea will harness key inflections and be a breakthrough success? What needs to be true for this to play out? What gives you confidence that this idea is worthy of your time and sacrifice?		
		Score above / Justification below
MISSION INTENTIONALITY		
Tests: mission intentionality, authenticity Listen for: pre-startup pull, emotional specificity Questions: Why are you doing this? Do you have a personal connection to the problem? If this company failed, what would you still feel compelled to fix in the world?		
		Score above / Justification below
EXTRAORDINARY ACHIEVEMENTS AND DISTINCTIONS		
Tests: what extraordinary things has the founder accomplished that makes them stand out? What is the founder X factor? Listen for: top placement in math Olympiad/usamsca/academia, publications, patents, scholarships, awards, sports, military, startups, etc. Questions: What is your greatest achievement, what are you most proud of? What makes you stand out from others? What important skillset and past experience gives you an unfair advantage to succeed?		
		Score above / Justification below
WORK ETHIC, RESOURCEFULNESS & EXECUTION BIAS		
Tests: hustle, bias to action, scrappiness, creativity with limited resources Listen for: indication of long hours, obsession with the product and iterating on customer feedback quickly Questions: What did you personally ship or change in the last two weeks? What's something creative you've done to make or raise money? What's the fastest experiment you've run recently?		
		Score above / Justification below
GRIT & PERSEVERANCE		
Tests: overcoming adversity, taking ownership, emotional maturity Listen for: stories of success despite long odds, no blame Questions: What's the hardest obstacle you've had to overcome in your life? Describe a time when you achieved something big and important despite long odds. What keeps you going when things get hard?		
		Score above / Justification below
MAGNETISM		
Tests: leadership, storytelling/credibility, and ability to attract talent, customers, and capital Listen for: early believers/subscribers/investors, do you get excited when listening to them talk about their idea? Questions: Who are the best people who have joined or advised you so far—and why? Tell me a story you use to explain your idea to prospective employees What feedback do you consistently get after telling your story?		
		Score above / Justification below
INTELLECTUAL CURIOSITY		
Tests: curiosity about the world, ability to learn new things quickly Listen for: obsession with learning new things Questions: What's something you learned recently that changed how you operate? What are your favorite AI tools and what have you built recently? What are you reading, listening to, or studying right now? What's a question you're obsessed with?		
		Score above / Justification below
COACHABILITY, SELF AWARENESS, & EQ		
Tests: adaptability, intellectual honesty, emotional intelligence Listen for: firm opinions but openness to new ideas, honesty about weaknesses Questions: What's a strongly held belief you changed in the last year? What are your weaknesses/blindspots and how do you compensate for them? What feedback have you received that was hard to hear but true? How do you think your co-founder would describe working with you?		
		Score above / Justification below
TEAM CHEMISTRY		
Tests: founders work well together and complement one another Listen for: tenure of knowing one another, what fueled the attraction Questions: How long have you been working together? How did you meet? How do you divide up your work? How do you complement one another? What do you enjoy most about working together?		
		Score above / Justification below
QUESTIONS		WHO
Topic	Question	Owner